

Tiny Bodies, Big Brains — Module 07:

Communication — Think About It

Part A: Family Discussion Questions

1. How do you know if a dog is happy? (Tail wag! Animals communicate without words).
2. How many ways can you say "Hello"? (Wave, smile, bow, handshake, hug — so many!).
3. Why do babies babble before they talk? (Practicing sounds — building the language system).
4. What was your first word? Ask your parents — they probably remember!
5. Can you communicate with just your face? How many emotions can your face show?
6. Why is it easier to understand someone in person than in a text message? (You can see their face and hear their tone).
7. What is "Body Language"? (The way your body communicates — crossed arms, slumped shoulders, big smile).
8. Do animals have language? How do bees, dolphins, or birds communicate?
9. What happens in your brain when you hear a story? (It lights up as if you are living the story!).
10. Why do different families speak different languages? (Brains are flexible — they learn whatever language surrounds them).

Part B: Hands-On Activities and Reflection

1. Play "Emotions Charades": Write feelings on cards (excited, nervous, bored, proud, confused). Act them out using only your face and body. Can your family guess?
2. Record a family member telling a short story. Play it back. Can you hear the emotions in their voice? Tone carries as much meaning as words.
3. Try to have a five-minute conversation using ONLY gestures and drawings (no words, no letters). What was hardest to communicate?
4. Learn to say "Thank you" in three new languages today. Practice at dinner. Your brain just added new communication tools!

5. Watch a short video with the sound off. Can you understand what is happening? How much communication comes through visually?
6. Make a "Family Dictionary" of special words, phrases, or inside jokes that only your family uses. Every family has its own mini-language!
7. Read a picture book together. Take turns telling the story using only the pictures.
Different people will tell different stories from the same images!
8. Sit facing a family member. Mirror their facial expression for 30 seconds. How does copying someone's expression make you feel their emotion? (Mirror neurons at work!).
9. Draw a comic strip where two characters have a miscommunication. Show what went wrong and how they fixed it. Share with the family.
10. Before bed, say something kind to every family member — not just "goodnight," but something specific. ("I liked when you helped me with my puzzle today"). Watch how specific communication lights up their face.